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Myth in Irawati Karve: The Contemporary Perspective

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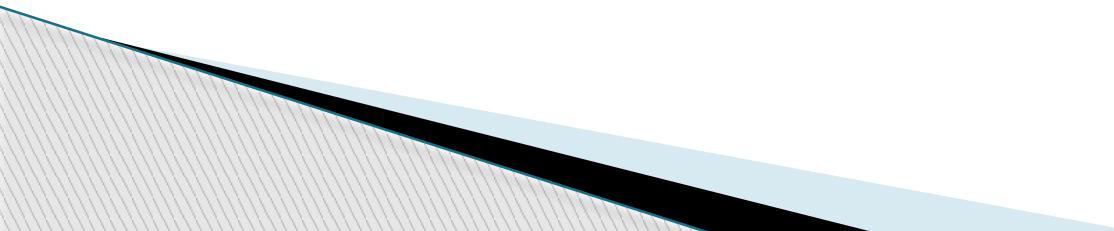
Introduction

- ▶ When we step into the enchanting world of Indian mythology, where gods and goddesses dance amidst celestial realms and mortal worlds, weaving tales of cosmic battles and divine love we discover the epic sagas of the Mahabharata and the Ramayana, where righteousness clashes with destiny, and heroes rise amidst the turmoil of ancient conflicts. Delve into the intricate web of myths, where every story is a tapestry of symbolism and allegory, offering profound insights into the human condition and the eternal quest for truth and enlightenment. Embark on a journey through the rich tapestry of Indian myth, where the boundaries between the seen and the unseen blur, and the mystical echoes of ancient wisdom resonate through the ages.

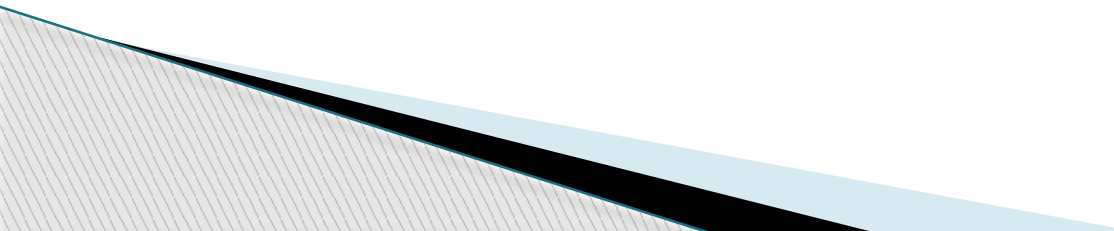
Introduction

- ▶ Myth" refers to a traditional story, typically involving supernatural beings, ancestors, or heroes, that explains aspects of the natural world, customs, religious beliefs, or cultural practices. Myths are found in every culture and are often passed down orally from generation to generation.
- Key Characteristics of Myths:
 - Symbolic and Allegorical: Myths often convey deeper truths or values through symbolic storytelling.
 - Explanatory: They attempt to explain natural phenomena (like creation myths), social customs, or historical events.
 - Cultural Significance: Myths reflect the beliefs, fears, and values of the culture they come from.
 - Supernatural Elements: They often feature gods, spirits, monsters, or otherworldly beings.

Introduction

- ▶ Types of Myths: Creation Myths – Stories about how the world or humanity began. Hero Myths – Tales of heroic figures and their adventures (e.g., Hercules, Gilgamesh). Cosmic Myths – Stories explaining the structure or fate of the universe. Etiological Myths – Explain why something is the way it is (e.g., why the sun rises).
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Introduction

- ▶ Greek Mythology: The tale of Prometheus stealing fire for humans. Norse Mythology: The end-of-the-world prophecy called Ragnarok. Hindu Mythology: The creation of the universe by the god Brahma. Native American Myths: Stories of earth divers creating land from the sea.
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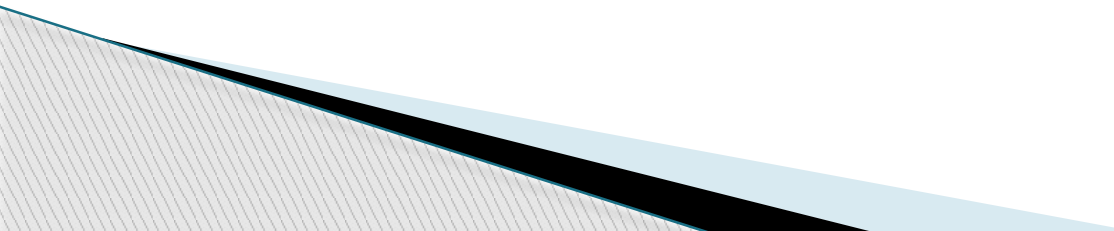
Introduction

- ▶ "Yuganta: The End of an Epoch" by Irawati Karve is a captivating exploration of the characters and events of the Indian epic, the Mahabharata. Through meticulous analysis and scholarly insight, Karve probes into the complexities of the epic, offering fresh perspectives on its timeless themes and characters. With a keen eye for detail and a deep understanding of Indian culture, history, and mythology, Karve presents a rich tapestry of narratives, unraveling the moral dilemmas and psychological depths of the Mahabharata's protagonists. From the enigmatic Krishna to the tragic figure of Draupadi, Karve's work sheds new light on these iconic figures, inviting readers to reconsider their roles and significance within the epic tradition. As a seminal work of Indian scholarship, "Yuganta" stands as a testament to Karve's intellectual prowess and her ability to illuminate the enduring relevance of ancient texts in contemporary discourse.

Background of the study

- ▶ "Yuganta: The End of an Epoch" is an important work by Irawati Karve, a renowned Indian anthropologist and sociologist. Published in 1967, the book emerged from Karve's deep engagement with Indian culture, history, and mythology. Drawing upon her expertise in anthropology and her extensive research, Karve offers a unique interpretation of the characters and events of the Indian epic, the Mahabharata. Through "Yuganta," Karve sought to provide a nuanced understanding of the moral dilemmas, psychological complexities, and socio-cultural dynamics depicted in the Mahabharata. Her interdisciplinary approach and insightful analysis have cemented "Yuganta" as a landmark contribution to Indian scholarship, influencing generations of readers and scholars alike. Karve's work continues to be celebrated for its depth of insight, clarity of expression, and enduring relevance to the study of Indian literature and mythology.

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- ▶ Additionally, the socio-political climate of India in the mid-20th century, marked by post-independence nation-building efforts and cultural renaissance, provides a backdrop against which "Yuganta" can be contextualized. Furthermore, understanding the significance of the Mahabharata in Indian culture and its enduring influence on literature, philosophy, and social thought is crucial for appreciating the depth and relevance of Karve's interpretation. Thus, the background of the study on "Yuganta" encompasses Karve's academic legacy, the socio-political milieu of her time, and the cultural importance of the Mahabharata in Indian society.
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Literature Review

- ▶ 1 In her book 'Yuganta' for which she received the Sahitya Academy Award in 1968 Dr. Karve delved into mythology presenting it as an event, in history. (Karellia ,Gopi 2020)
- ▶ 2 It requires a deal of bravery, on her part to question an epic that is still referenced in discussions about morality and values and to initiate a dialogue about it. I must acknowledge that her investigations, into the circumstances surrounding history's women were long overdue. (Rai, Himanshu 2006)
- ▶ 3 Regardless of whether the narrative's scientifically accurate or not the social sciences and humanities (such, as anthropology, psychology, philosophy, religious studies, political science and sociology) view myths as a pathway to understanding progress. Even if myths have been disproven they can still serve purposes. Myths promote beliefs. Contribute to building social cohesion, identity and community through established customs. The term "myth" now encompasses more than a container, for falsehoods. It includes ideas and beliefs that we inherit as part of our shared culture. (Athina, Maria et al 2019)

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- ▶ 4 Each individual possesses their complexities and nuances. "Yuganta " written by Iravati Karve emphasizes the importance of acknowledging this reality. We should strive to understand their life experiences and historical context without passing judgment on their choices or actions. (Kumar,Anand2018)
- ▶ 5 What is interesting is how she approaches the Mahabharata viewing it not as a text but rather as a historical voyage that provides valuable anthropological insights, from that time period. (DrAnshu's2021)
- ▶ 6. "Yuganta" feels like a compilation of essays rather, than a traditional novel. The author provides her viewpoints and understanding of the characters and events. When discussing Draupadi, Kunti, Gandhari, Krishna and Karna she skillfully captures the layers of their personalities. (Kurup,Pushpa 2017)

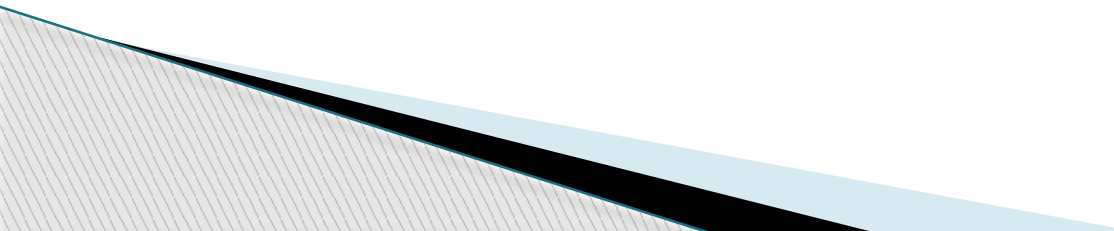
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- ▶ 7. Iravati Karve, the groundbreaking icon excelled in her portrayal of these characters skillfully humanizing them and subjecting them to her keen examination. (Godbole, Divya 2018)
- ▶ 8. She openly challenges their intentions and actions not shying away, from any topic. (Sharma ,Nishant2018)
- ▶ 9. Indian mythology prompts us to contemplate the relationship, between causes and effects. Irrespective of possessions Indian mythology places significance on one's identity. It expands its perspective. It delves into concepts of boundless wisdom. (Pattnaik, Devdutt 2017)

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- ▶ 10. According to Natalie Haynes "Human nature remains relatively constant" which means that these myths continue to hold significance in the day. They offer us an outlook, on the impact of violence and conflict, on individuals. (Ontiverous, Eva 2020)
- ▶ 11. Revisionist myth making, as per Natalie Haynes suggests that human nature remains relatively unchanged. This implies that these myths continue to hold relevance in our lives providing insights into the effects of violence and conflict on individuals. Taking a perspective we can reinterpret these myths to challenge male dominated environments. Indian feminist writers are exploring this genre to showcase that there are perspectives, beyond the male centric viewpoint(Das, Dee 2019)

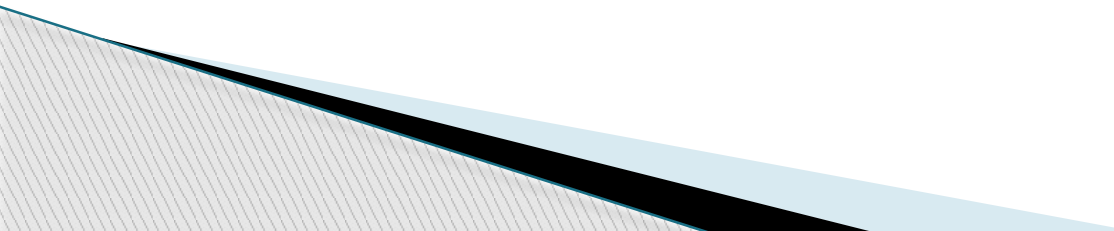
Research Gap

- ▶ 1. In every myth there are ideals. Although Yuganta discusses all the protagonists of The Mahabharata none of the characters are portrayed as heroic figures.
 - ▶ 2. While she encouraged women to advocate for rights or greater rights it appears that she was critical of Draupadi when she spoke out against injustice, in the Kuru Sabha during her disrobing.
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- ▶ “Ladies, while fighting with men for rights, why fight for only equal rights? Always fight for more rights,” she would often say in her lectures and community gatherings.” (Irawati Karve)
- ▶ But at the same time she derided Draupadi as
- ▶ “ Lady Pundit” (Yuganta , 1968)

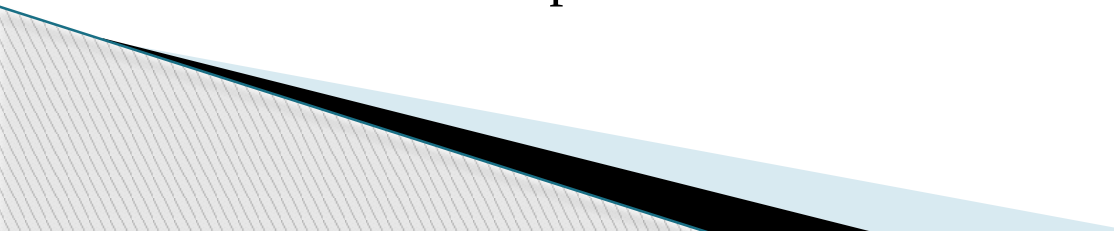
Research Objective

- ▶ 1. To find out how myth criticism can be used to study The Mahabharata from a contemporary perspective.
 - ▶ 2. To find how important are myths in human psyche and the social order especially during these chaotic times.
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Research Questions

- ▶ How does the author utilize myth in her retelling of The Mahabharat, and what significance does this approach add to the narrative?
 - ▶ In what ways does Irawati Karve employ Intersectional feminism in her study, and what insights does this perspective offer into the dynamics of the narratives she explores?
 - ▶ What are the implications of viewing myth as literature, particularly in terms of its potential for artistic creativity and the exploration of new possibilities?
 - ▶ How does the examination of myth expose specific aspects of the overall legendary structure, contributing to the individuality and coherence of a historical period's thought and art?
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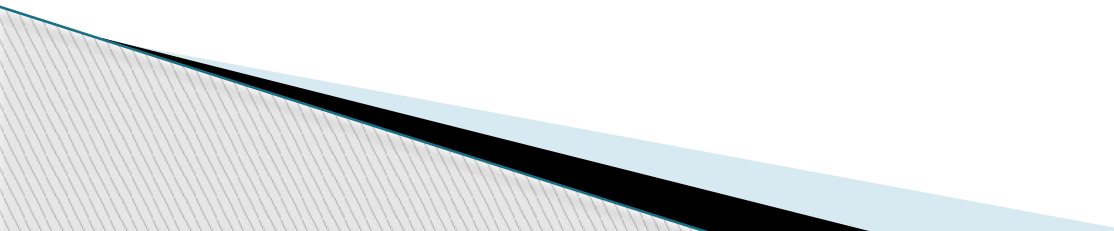
Research Methodology

- ▶ In this study we have used the methods of myth criticism and feminist concern. It has been already mentioned that feminism is a mode of analysis of literary text written by women from woman subjectivity and point of view. However, in our course of research it was also necessary to employ some of the ideas and insights from different disciplines and theories including Social Criticism, Feminist Concern, and Indian Ethos. Since the objective is to understand the ideas and visions in the works of Dr Irawati Karve from a contemporary perspective, the methodology drew on the approaches and the critical insights that may contribute to our study. Since the focus of the research is to examine the relevance of the views of this great writer, a close study of her works was more fruitful rather than depending on the critical interpretation of other critics.
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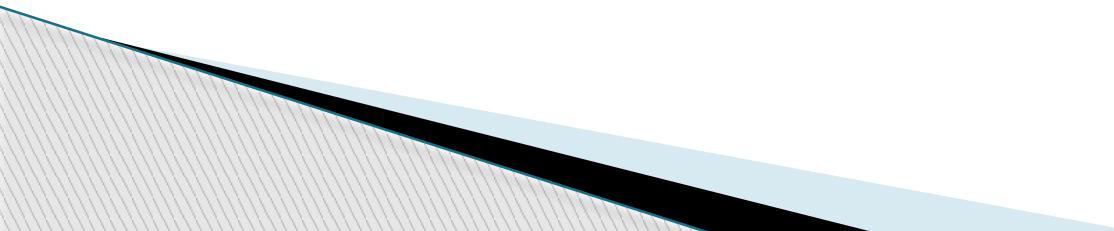
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- ▶ However, the interpretation of other critics was taken into account wherever it was relevant for the reinforcement of the meaning of the works with reference to the feminist issues of marginality, cultural identity and myth criticism.

Chapter wise discussion

- ▶ The thesis is divided into the following chapters.
 - ▶ Chapter 1- Introduction
 - ▶ Chapter 2- Myth and Myth Criticism
 - ▶ Chapter 3-The Contemporary Perspective of Myth
 - ▶ Chapter 4- Social Criticism and Myth in Irawati Karve
 - ▶ Chapter-5 Feminist Concern and Myth in Irawati Karve
 - ▶ Chapter 6-Myth and Indian Ethos in Irawati Karve
 - ▶ Chapter 7- Conclusion
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First Chapter- Introduction

- ▶ In the opening chapter titled "Introduction " the focus is on establishing the backdrop for the narrative. It highlights the significance of language in fiction writing along with exploring how myth, imagery and metaphors are employed in Iravati Karve's works. This chapter investigates her background, her contributions and provides a concise overview of one of her novels.
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- ▶ Irawati Karve's "Yuganta –The End of An Epoch" is based on "The Mahabharata". For the author it is-
- ▶ 1. A historical core—(Itihasa) something which really happened,
- ▶ 2. An exquisite narration where one becomes aware of the full strength, brevity and beauty of the Sanskrit language,
- ▶ 3. An aesthetic experience,
- ▶ 4. A representative and fascinating picture of an epoch." (Karve 8).

Continued

- ▶ The book undertakes an examination and analysis of the characters and events portrayed in the Indian epic, the Mahabharata. Karve approaches this revered epic with a contemporary perspective delving into its moral and ethical dilemmas. In "Yuganta " Karve transcends interpretations of the Mahabharata to offer a nuanced and psychologically insightful exploration of its characters. She particularly emphasizes their motivations and behaviors questioning the idealization and presenting them as individuals, with their own imperfections and conflicts. The title "Yuganta" itself can be interpreted as "The End of an Epoch" or "The End of an Era." Within this book Karve discusses how the Mahabharata symbolizes the conclusion of an era or yuga, in history.

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- ▶ Karve wrote on Hindu society, kinship, caste system and travel narratives. Irawati Karve's main focus revolved around Hindu society and its caste system as Kinship Organization in India. She extensively explored the Mahabharata treating its protagonists as figures to gain insight into their attitudes and behaviors within their context. Her research primarily probed into the makeup of the population kinship structures in India, the origins of the caste system and sociological analyses of rural and urban communities. In her work "Hindu Society. An interpretation" (Deccan College, 1961) Karve presented a study of Hindu society based on field research data and analysis of texts in Hindi, Marathi, Sanskrit, Pali and Prakrit languages. Within this book she discussed the Aryan roots of the caste system in Hinduism and traced its evolution to its current form. Irawati Karve proposed that Indian caste society comprises independent units, with distinct behavioral patterns resulting in a diversity of norms and behaviors .

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- ▶ In "Yuganta: The End of an Epoch," Irawati Karve employs a language that is both scholarly and accessible. She writes in a clear and straightforward manner, making complex historical and mythological concepts understandable to a wide audience. Karve's language is precise and analytical, reflecting her background as an anthropologist and her deep understanding of Indian culture, history, and mythology. She avoids unnecessary jargon, making the text engaging and informative for readers with varying levels of familiarity with the subject matter. Overall, her language in "Yuganta" is characterized by its clarity, depth, and accessibility.

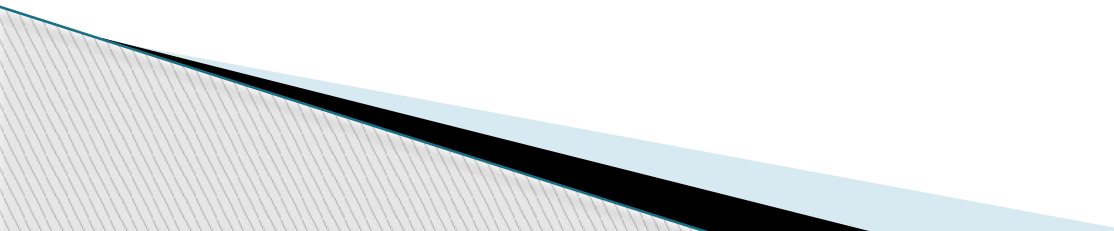
Analysis

- ▶ Irawati Karve's *Yuganta* is a retelling of The Mahabharata that intertwines history, culture and philosophy of times in a sociological manner. This work stands out as a piece of literature, a sociological examination, an anthropological and cultural record reflecting human needs and responses that resonate across time periods. The Mahabharata explores issues that are fundamentally human in nature. Irawati presents characters and their actions without judgment but rather through the objective lens of events that have influenced and shaped different individuals destinies. In her role as a sociologist Irawati conducts a study on behavior while as an anthropologist she provides insightful research on the physical, social and cultural development of humans in her groundbreaking work “*Yuganta- The end of an Epoch*”.

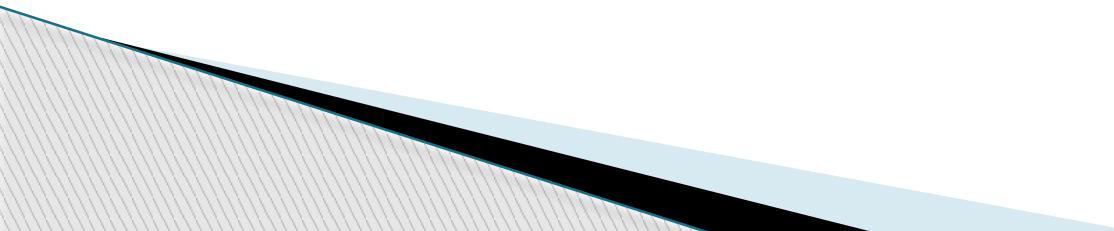
Chapter 2 - Myth and Myth Criticism

- ▶ The second chapter attempts to define Myth and Myth Criticism and their use in the novel and its relevance in the present society.
- ▶ The word "myth" comes from the Greek word mythos, which can mean "tale" or "story," and a myth is essentially a story. For many, such a broad definition is of no use, and some would add the caution that a myth must be a "traditional" tale or story, one that has shown to be of such lasting value that it is regularly retold, regardless of the medium used by the artist/storyteller.
- ▶ Myth-Criticism is a literary interpretation strategy that can be used in conjunction with other approaches and reading techniques. When an artist incorporates a traditional myth into a literary work, the myth is rendered in a dialogical relationship with the work and the myth-tradition.

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- ▶ Myth criticism reintroduces spiritual meaning into our alienated society filled with science, technology, and empiricism by drawing on anthropological and psychological foundations of myth, ritual, and fairy tales. The human creation of myths - associated with magic, imagination and dreaming - is seen as integral to human intelligence because it allows for the creation of meaningful environments for human existence.
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- ▶ Frye uses transcendental genres like Romance (Summer) Tragedy (Fall) Satire (Winter) and Comedy (Spring) to form what he calls the "Central Unit of Myth" consisting of four types that reveal the general structure behind these types. Frye further explores the concept of Romantic stories where protagonists dive into abysses or endanger themselves before bouncing back up again.
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- ▶ Frye classifies myths into four categories:
- ▶ 1. The dawn, spring and birth and death phase. There are myths dealing with the birth of a hero, his revival and resurrection, defeat of the powers of darkness and death. Subordinate characters such as the father and the mother are introduced in the myth. Such myths are the archetypes of romance and of rhapsodic poetry.
- ▶ 2. The zenith, summer and marriage or triumph phase. In this phase, there are myths of apotheosis, (the act of being raised to the rank of a god), of sacred marriage and of entering into Paradise. Subordinate characters in these myths are the companion and the bride. Such myths are the archetypes of comedy, pastoral and idyll.

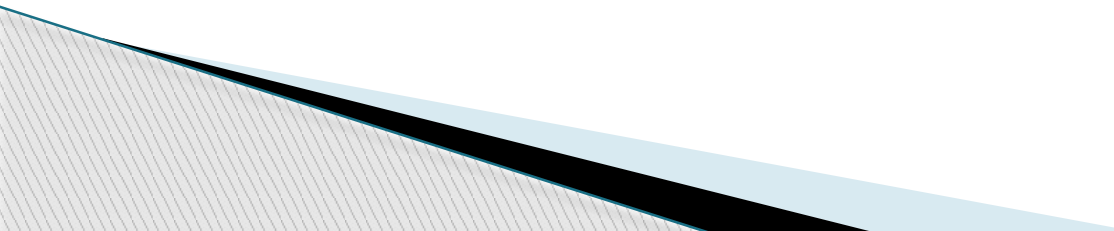
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- ▶ 3. The sunset, autumn and death phase. These are the myths dealing with the fall of a hero, a dying god, violent death, sacrifice and the hero's isolation. The subordinate characters are the traitor and the siren. Such myths are the archetypes of tragedy and elegy.
- 4. The darkness, winter and desolation phase. There are myths dealing with the triumph of these powers. The myths of floods, the return of chaos and the defeat of the hero are examples of this phase. The ogre and the witch are the subordinate characters here and these myths are the archetypes of satire.

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- ▶ Northrop Frye has established the validity of the archetypal approach and its relevance in the elucidation of a text. Like works of literature, criticism is also creative and an archetypal critic discovers the meaning of a text and the motives of a character

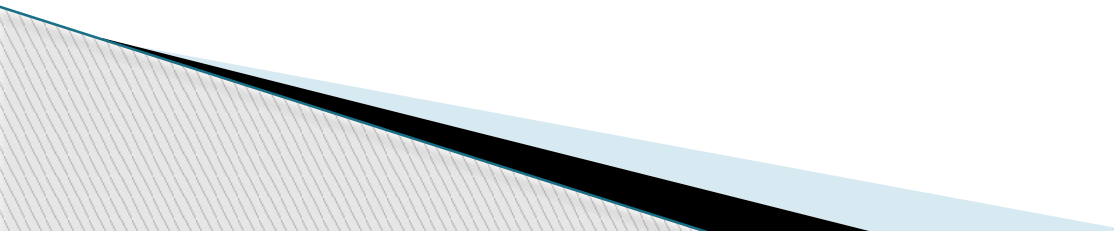
Analysis

- ▶ Throughout the world mythology holds importance. To probe deeper into its meaning and the influences it draws from historical backgrounds we rely on myth criticism. This analytical tool helps mythologists uncover archetypes, themes and symbols that provide context to the stories meanings. Moreover examining critiques of mythology sheds light on how cultures evolve alongside values and belief systems. This evolution, over time showcases how mythic language remains enduringly rich and accessible in all times.
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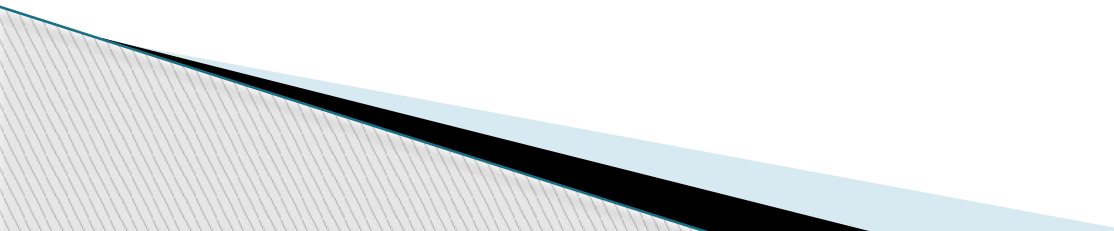
Chapter 3-The Contemporary Perspective of Myth

- ▶ In writings, on mythology there are creative interpretations and stories that are thoroughly explored and analyzed. These narratives often carry meanings that spark conversations and dialogues among readers, philosophers and scholars. Mythology can be seen as synonymous with ideology—the collection of beliefs and representations that uphold and legitimize existing power structures. Ideologies serve to promote the ideals and interests of the groups, within society. However in cultures there seems to be a lack of myths that offer significance and purpose. Therefore it becomes crucial to create myths that can provide people with a sense of identity, morality, community and creativity. In today's world the importance of myths should not be underestimated; in fact they hold relevance from a contemporary perspective.

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- ▶ First, myths often illuminate the origins and history of a community, creating a sense of continuity and connection to the past. By telling the stories of their ancestors and the founding of their communities, myths represent a shared cultural heritage that can help create a sense of unity and belonging among community members.
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- ▶ Second, myths often express values and beliefs that are important to a community and provide a framework for moral and ethical behavior. By telling the stories of heroic characters and their struggles against adversity, myths can inspire community members to emulate these virtues and uphold the values that are important to their community.
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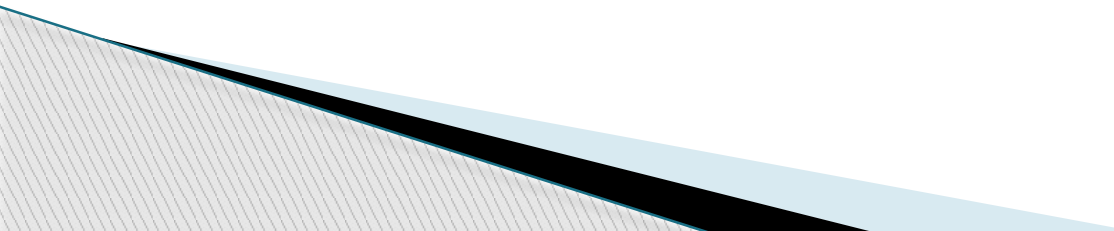
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- ▶ Third, myths can help create a shared sense of identity by providing a common language and symbol system. Using shared images, symbols, and metaphors, mythology can create a shared cultural vocabulary that helps bind community members together and differentiates them from other groups. Myths can confer community identity by providing a shared cultural heritage, a framework for moral and ethical behavior, and a shared language and symbol system. By creating a sense of continuity and connection to the past, motivating community members to adhere to shared values, and providing a common cultural vocabulary, myths can help create a sense of unity and belonging among community members.

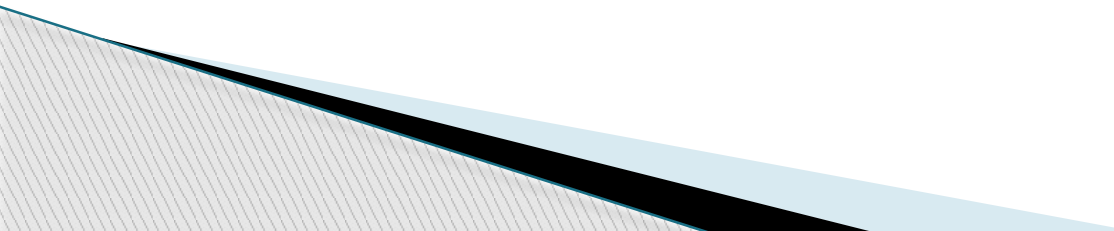
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- ▶ Contemporary perspectives on mythology refer to modern ways of understanding and interpreting mythology. While myths have ancient origins and were originally used to explain natural phenomena, cultural traditions, and the origins of societies, the way we explain them has evolved over time. Viewing mythology from a contemporary perspective requires recognizing that mythology is not only a relic of the past but is still relevant to modern life. This includes understanding that myths provide a glimpse into universal human experience and can help us form our perceptions of the planet around us.
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Analysis

- ▶ Iravati Karve's Yuganta provides a take, on the Mahabharata through character analyses. Viewing mythology from an angle allows us to grasp the aspects within Yuganta more profoundly. By delving into the underpinnings and emotional complexities of the characters Yuganta sheds light on how their actions mirror human experiences. Furthermore, this approach critiques the patriarchal and caste-driven society depicted in the Mahabharata offering insights into its implications today.
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- ▶ Through themes, like power, love, loyalty and betrayal Yuganta prompts us to reflect on our lives and communities. By presenting perspectives on the epics characters and events this contemporary lens encourages a multifaceted understanding that enriches our interpretation of this timeless tale.
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- ▶ When we probe into "Yuganta" by Irawati Karve from a perspective we can truly grasp its dissection of narratives and the significance of mythology, in today's context. It offers insights into cultural and psychological dimensions delves into the intricate personalities portrayed and delves into moral ambiguity and ethical dilemmas. Through this interpretation of the Mahabharata Karve's work emerges as a resource for academics and enthusiasts keen on exploring how ancient myths continue to resonate in our society. In essence examining mythology through a lens enables us to appreciate the relevance and significance of Yuganta. This approach provides an insight into the Mahabharata while highlighting its enduring impact, on culture and society.

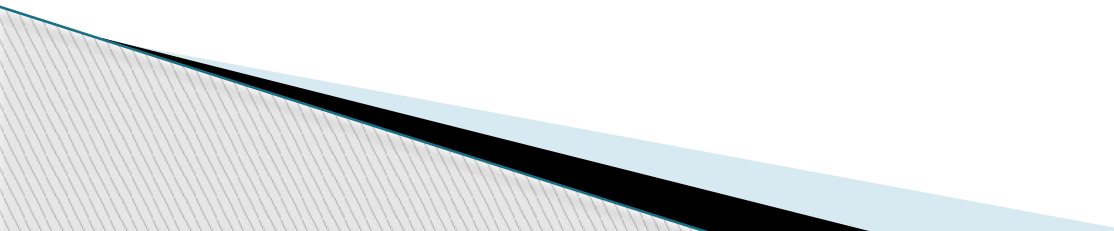
Chapter 4- Social Criticism and Myth in Irawati Karve

- ▶ Traditional literary works contain myths that have their own significance. Readers are practically unable to distinguish between myth and truth because they have been woven and stitched together so skillfully. Myths play an important role in traditional Indian literary works as a means of channeling criticism. Social criticism can be found in folktales, chronicles, and history-based literature. Irawati Karve uses both the techniques of myth and social criticism with equal aplomb to highlight the issues as portrayed in the novel. Those issues of discrimination, patriarchy and marginalization are still relevant. Social criticism is a type of academic or journalistic criticism that focuses on modern sociological concerns, particularly perceived injustices and power dynamics in general. Social criticism examines social institutions that are perceived to be wrong, with the goal of implementing practical changes through particular measures, radical reform, or even revolution.

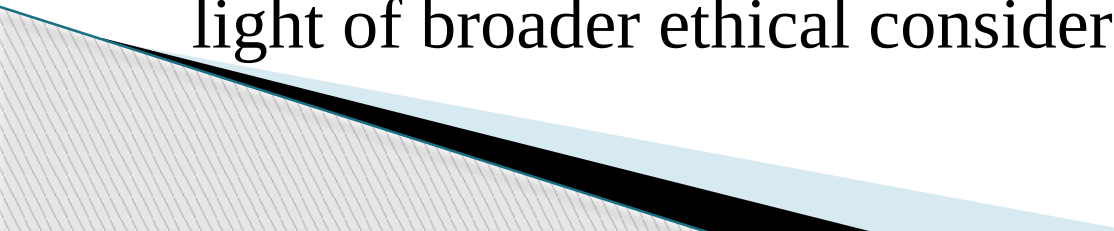
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- ▶ In her seminal work "Yuganta," Irawati Karve intertwines social criticism with the exploration of mythological narratives, offering incisive insights into the complexities of Indian society and human nature. Through meticulous analysis of characters and themes in the Mahabharata, Karve exposes underlying power structures, moral ambiguities, and societal injustices embedded within the epic. Her interdisciplinary approach not only delves into the psychological depths of characters but also sheds light on broader social issues such as caste, gender, and ethics.

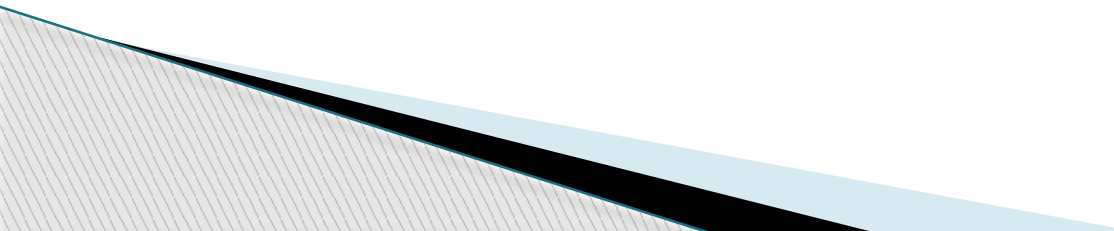
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- ▶ By critically examining myth through a sociocultural lens, Karve challenges prevailing norms and ideologies, inviting readers to confront uncomfortable truths and engage in introspection about the human condition. Through her nuanced portrayal of myth, Karve not only critiques societal norms but also underscores the enduring relevance of mythology as a mirror reflecting the complexities of human society and providing a platform for social critique and transformation.
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- ▶ Karve's fusion of social criticism and mythological analysis extends beyond mere deconstruction; it serves as a call to action for societal introspection and reform. By juxtaposing timeless mythological narratives with contemporary social realities, she highlights the enduring relevance of ancient wisdom in addressing modern challenges. Through her work, Karve emphasizes the transformative potential of myth as a tool for societal reflection and change, urging readers to critically reassess established norms and values in light of broader ethical considerations.
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- ▶ By bridging the gap between the ancient and the contemporary, Karve's approach to myth opens up avenues for dialogue, empathy, and collective action, fostering a deeper understanding of the interconnectedness of past and present and the imperative of ethical engagement in shaping a more just and equitable society.
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Analysis

- ▶ Throughout the ages, legends and myths have evolved beyond traditions and beliefs. They now tell tales of individuals facing life's challenges and coming out triumphant. These enchanting stories, from mythology, still hold our fascination weaving their magic in our minds. Our love for literature exploring these myths and legends is unwavering. Over time scholars from disciplines such as philosophy, anthropology, structuralism and feminism have used myths as a tool for discussions. By juxtaposing established concepts with narratives they give rise to perspectives and ideas. The development of theories is a journey where new insights build upon the foundation laid by the past. Present-day scholars like C.C. Barber and Mac Caffrey from Cambridge play roles in analysis within this realm. The future path of myth criticism depends on its convergence with fields or through a dialogue that delves into the genesis of myths through storytelling.

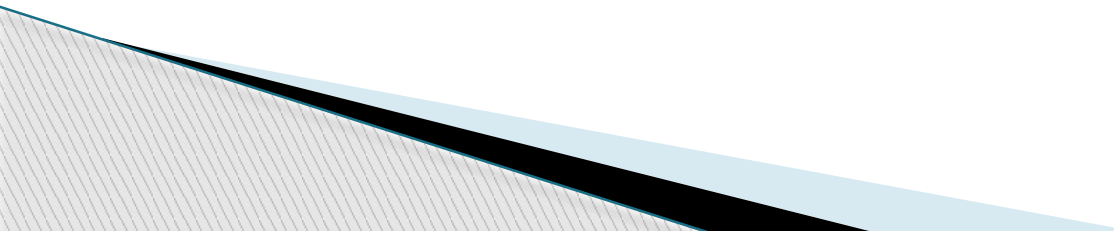
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- ▶ Renowned writers, like Homer, Sophocles, Virgil, Milton, Ezra Pound, T.S Eliot, James Joyce and Gabriel Garcia Marquez have reimagined myths in their works. Contemporary narratives will spark inquiries and theoretical discussions as long as myths continue to inspire creations that lead to the evolution of mythologies.
 - ▶ Myth criticism differs from frameworks, like structuralism or post-colonialism in that it places an emphasis on adapting stories to connect with contemporary audiences. This adaptation is crucial, for ensuring its significance and influence.
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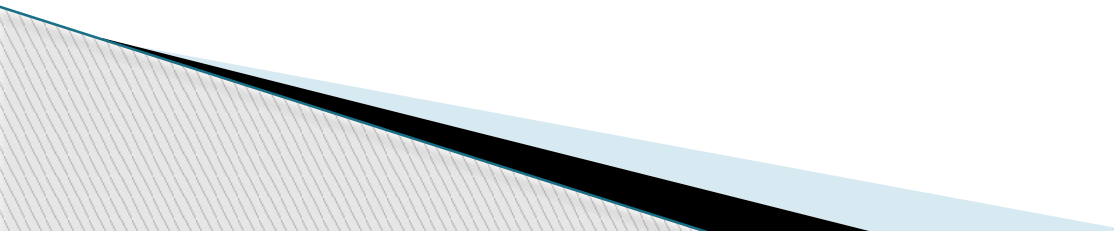
Chapter-5 Feminist Concern and Myth in Irawati Karve

- ▶ Feminist concerns arise from persistent instances of gender inequality and discrimination in today's society despite significant progress in education and employment opportunities for women or non-binary individuals. Systemic barriers continue to hinder their ability to achieve equal rights and opportunity access. Some issues feminists address includes violence against women, reproductive rights violations while media often portrays the female form crudely or erotically on the screen or print media: all these matters worsen how people perceive others based on their sex/gender choices. The adverse effects extend beyond personal inconvenience; it amplifies misogynistic worldviews reflecting on societal attitudes towards marginalized genders - which is also why these support men who face similar struggles caused by existing patriarchal norms.

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- ▶ Creating an equitable society free from bias based on one's gender is central to feminism's driving force. To accomplish this objective requires granting fundamental rights such as equality, opportunity & dignity which are parallel regardless of one's gender. The feminist movement has brought about empowerment among countless individuals through various channels.
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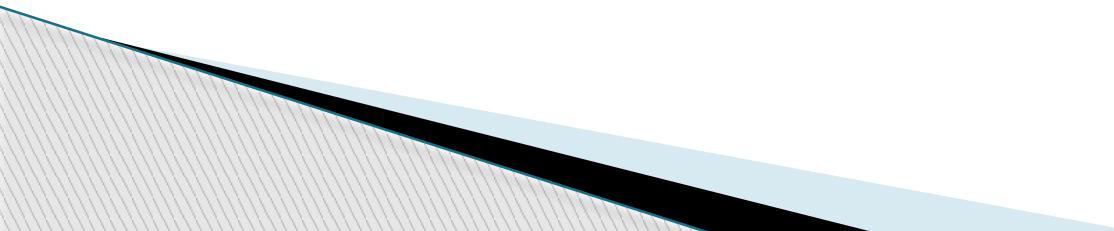
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- ▶ Contemporary feminisms continue making strides politically today with issues concerning the under-representation of women, their leadership in those areas while also focusing on other global issues such as gender-based-violence or equal pay bases for equal work. These feminist concerns about social justice teach valuable lessons applicable across different domains.
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- ▶ In "Yuganta: The End of an Epoch " Karve also focused on feminist discourse using it to question Mahabharata's text as heavily patriarchal with weak character portrayals for women. While women may have been portrayed as powerless concerning narrative plot development Irawati Karve highlights instances where female characters have a modicum of autonomy that can be harnessed to create more egalitarian societies where gender power dynamics are non-oppressive

Continued

- ▶ Ultimately Irawati Karve's critical approach to deeply entrenched patriarchy in Indian society highlights the need for transformative change where societal norms must evolve along with ideas governing social disparities if progress is truly desired within India. Her writings remain a source of inspiration among various scholars both in India and throughout the world when addressing gender issues while also tackling caste discrimination.
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- ▶ As per Karve's feministic perspective, this epic portrays a patriarchal society where male domination oppressed women causing them limited agency. Yet these same women show tenacity, resilience while achieving their goals with dignity.

Analysis

- ▶ The Fifth chapter in this research deals with Feminist Concern and Myth in Irawati Karve. Feminism recognizes that women view the world through their lenses and express themselves based on their individual perspectives. In the realm of literature feminism has progressed steadily than, over time. Renowned writers like Bankimchandra Chatterji and Rabindranath Tagore in Bengali, Jitendra Kumar in Hindi and Saratchandra Chatterji have depicted women in ways that reflect ideals spanning centuries. Ismat Chughtais Urdu literary works are known for challenging norms with their content. Rashid Iqlams stories from the 1930s including "Angare" and "Aurat" (The Woman) delve into issues related to women's experiences.

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- ▶ Contemporary Indian female authors often delve into exploring lives and intricate relationships as individualism and dissent are not widely embraced in our culture with marital happiness and a woman's domestic role remaining themes. This emerging literary movement not captures a sensibility but also conveys a sense of cultural displacement. Present day women exhibit liberation, in their viewpoints and eloquence compared to older times. To truly understand feminism from a perspective it is crucial to appreciate the captivating narrative offered by feminism.

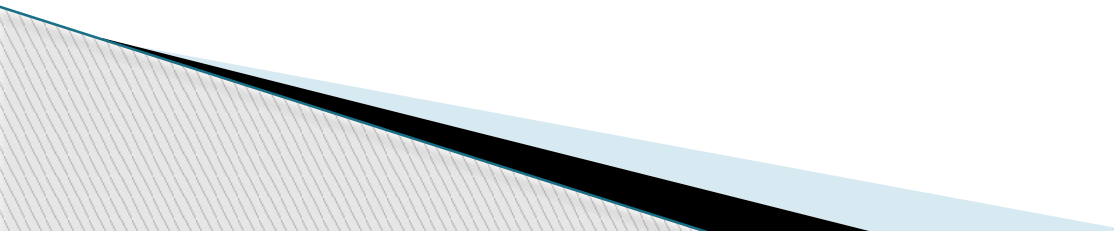
Chapter 6-Myth and Indian Ethos in Irawati Karve

- ▶ Chapter six will delve into the ethos exploring its roots, in scriptures, epics and the rich oral tradition of storytelling and mythology that has been passed down through generations. Drawing from the wisdom of the Upanishads, Bhagwat Gita and Puranas the Indian ethos embodies a set of principles rooted in behavior. It encourages individuals to find harmony between their worldly pursuits embracing both materialism and spirituality. In her work Irawati Karve skillfully weaves myth into her narrative providing us with insights into the significance of myth and its role in preserving our traditions and culture in modern times.

Continued

- ▶ Indian culture is complex with many dimensions shaped largely by its mythology underpinning the concept of "Indian Ethos". This concept signifies a collection of core values and beliefs producing a dynamic society deeply rooted in traditions inherited from past generations. A pivotal element within Indian mythology is dharma: an integrated framework governing individuals' moral compass reflecting community-engaged behavior rooted in Hindu morality principles. Described through characters' encounters involving morals depicted by Mahabharata epic, it reinforced apt standards necessitating conduct predicated on communal good by leading exemplary lives.

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- ▶ While being transcendent to Hinduism, the idea of Indian Ethos embodies key concepts that are shared among various religions such as Buddhism, Jainism & Sikhism; centered on principles of compassion, non-violence & selflessness towards building united communities. Mythology, through shaping cultural tapestry plays a crucial role in maintaining these traditional values against current globalization because it emphasizes preserving our heritage ensuring its continuation into future generations.
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- ▶ “Myths and tales play a role, in shaping the culture of a society. In times people relied on these stories to understand the world around them particularly when it came to explaining phenomena. At its core a myth is a narrative that sheds light on how the world came to be as we know it. Many captivating stories in literature draw inspiration from two epics, the Mahabharata and Ramayana as well as ancient Hindu scriptures called Puranas. These enchanting narratives captivate readers with their characters and events that hold significance in history.
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- ▶ “The Mahabharata in particular serves as an encyclopedia of sorts containing stories, about gods, kings and philosophical and ethical teachings. It delves into every aspect of humanity both the good and the bad. While some parts may have hints of truth waiting to be uncovered and verified it's important to note that the primary focus of this epic is DHARMA. An essential concept found throughout Hindu scriptures.” (Chamoli, Khare, Gupta 3).

Continued

- ▶ One pivotal aspect of Indian mythology is dharma – a framework that governs individuals' moral compasses and reflects behavior that is altruistic, reflecting Hindu morality and principles.

Analysis

- ▶ Irawati Karve's Yuganta is a piece of work remarkable for its character portrayal and logical explanations of events that took place thousands of years ago. It explores the epic, as a narrative about the struggles and imperfections of beings, their insecurities, anger and desire, for revenge. However, it also highlights their bravery and strong sense of honor. This book provides an understanding of what scientific temperament means. In this exploration of our heritage it becomes evident that we require more of this mindset given the unfortunate bitterness that has permeated our national discourse.

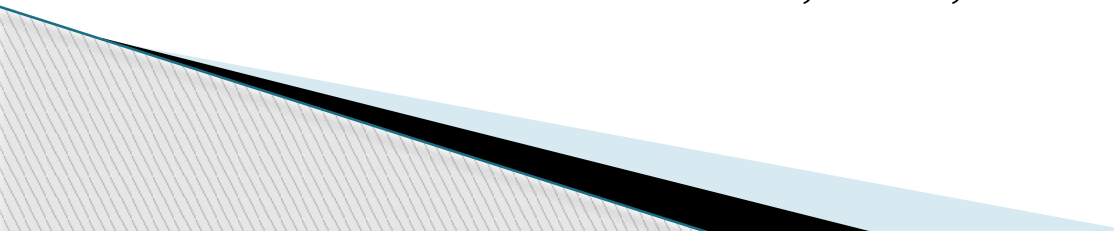
Chapter 7- Conclusion

- ▶ In the 7th chapter we will present our findings. When we reflect on our history and the unfortunate and divisive animosity that currently pervades our national dialogue it becomes clear that we could greatly benefit from more myths and spiritual texts to guide us in all aspects of life. These tales serve as guardians imparting life lessons through their portrayal of characters and events. Karve, a writer, skillfully crafts believable characters who possess both human qualities and flaws. Some characters are inherently idealistic yet still exhibit traits due to their imperfections. Others endure hardships resulting from their circumstances.

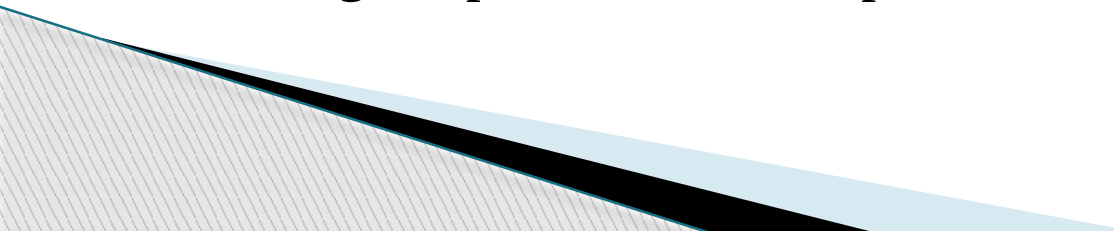
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- ▶ Despite their attempts to uphold values they find themselves entangled in corruption; nevertheless at the heart of the novel lies their struggle against these unfavorable circumstances. Karve's insightful reflections, on myth and contemporary reality are expressed eloquently shedding light on the challenges faced by humans and elevating her writing to the realm of art.

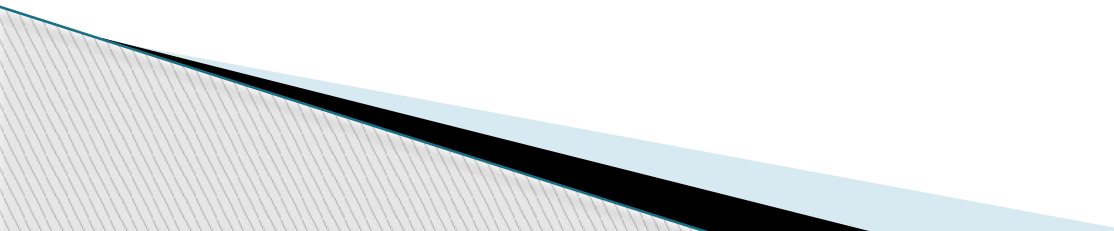
Conclusion

- ▶ "Yuganta" by Irawati Karve indeed offers a refreshing perspective on the characters of the Mahabharata. Karve's approach to exploring the characters is deeply humanizing, as she delves into their moral complexities and psychological depths. Rather than presenting them as mere mythological figures, Karve brings out their relatable traits and vulnerabilities, making them more accessible to modern readers.
 - ▶ One of the key strengths of "Yuganta" lies in Karve's ability to challenge traditional interpretations of the Mahabharata. By questioning established narratives and delving into the intricacies of each character's motivations and actions, she invites readers to reconsider their understanding of the epic. This analytical approach not only sheds light on the moral ambiguities within the Mahabharata but also prompts readers to reflect on broader themes such as human nature, ethics, and the consequences of one's choices.
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- ▶ Karve's insights into the psychological nuances of the characters add depth to the narrative, allowing readers to empathize with their struggles and dilemmas. Through her nuanced portrayal, she highlights the universal aspects of the human experience encapsulated within the epic, transcending cultural and temporal boundaries.
 - ▶ So, "Yuganta" stands out as a thought-provoking exploration of the Mahabharata, offering a fresh and insightful perspective on its legendary characters. Karve's meticulous analysis and humanistic approach make it a compelling read for anyone interested in delving deeper into the complexities of this ancient epic.
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- ▶ Myths often assume renewed versions to convey specific morals or messages that resonate with readers through different retelling styles. One way is to simplify ancient language or adapt stories tailored according to certain audiences without losing original ideals; another approach involves shifting focus from a particular deity towards highlighting charitable deeds or compassion.
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- ▶ “Myths serve as explanations, for the core aspects of existence shedding light on the origins of our knowledge and our purpose in this world and the direction we are headed. It is crucial to note that when we refer to "myth" it is not meant to suggest falsehood but to acknowledge its nature.”(Keating 3)

Conclusion

- ▶ In her book "Yuganta; The End of an Era " Irawati Karve presents an analysis of the characters and events, in the Indian epic, the Mahabharata from a perspective that goes beyond simple literary analysis. She delves into the complexities of behavior societal structures and moral uncertainties. Karve's perceptive study navigates through the layers of myth and folklore examining the motives and deeds of figures like Krishna, Draupadi and Karna while also exploring the backdrop of ancient India. By blending research, psychological insights and philosophical reflections Karve encourages readers to rethink their perceptions of these revered personalities and their timeless struggles. Her nuanced viewpoints resonate with discussions on power dynamics, ethics and human nature. Through "Yuganta " Karve not only enhances our understanding of the Mahabharata but also encourages us to contemplate on the enduring significance of its themes and teachings in our present day lives.

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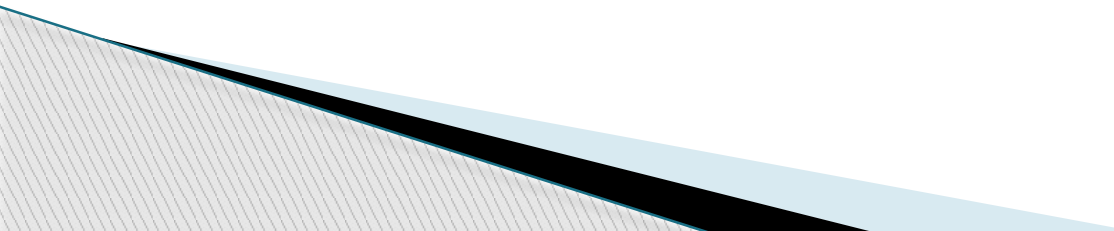
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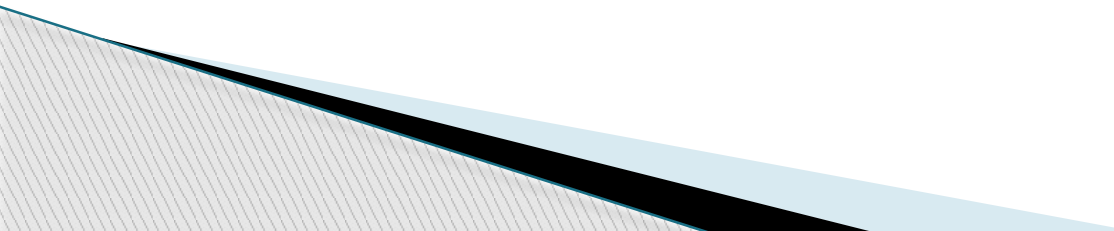
- ▶ 1Intersectionality and Discrimination based on Caste in the Mahabharata- A system well fought. Presented at The Interdisciplinary International Conference on Mahābhārata Epic Across Asia:

Ancient Indian Knowledge System Transcending Spatio-Temporal Boundaries, conducted by EFLU on the 29th,30th and 31st May 2023.

Continued

- ▶ A study on Intersectionality and multiple discrimination at the workplace: Does it create a negative synergy, presented at the 2 day International Conference titled- “ Representation of Violence in Literature and Media” held on 30th and 31st May 2023.
 - ▶ International Conference on Gender and Politics In Media and Literature held on 10th February,2023 organised by Amity School of Communication and Amity Institute of Social Science , Amity University Gwalior.
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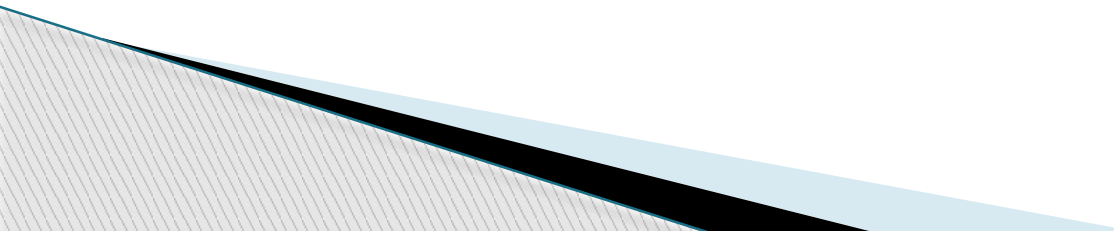
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- ▶ Participated and presented a paper titled “Interpreting the Multi-Layered Narrative Structure Of The Mahabharata – A study of Textuality and Intertextuality at the International Conference on “Contemporary Perspectives in English Language, Literature and Cultural Studies” –(ICCEP-2023) held from 14-15th July 2023 , organised by Department of English, University Institute for Liberal Arts and Humanities, Chandigarh University.
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- ▶ Participated and presented paper in the National Seminar on
 - ▶ Reinventing Indian English Literature Across the Post-Independence Era
 - ▶ Organized by
 - ▶ Faculty of Arts, Communication and Indic Studies (FACIS) Sri Sri University.
 - ▶ In collaboration with SRJAN
 - ▶ Title of the paper-The Reimagining of Myth in Irawati Karve's work- A Critical Study
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- ▶ Participated in the “ International Seminar on Pain Studies” conducted by VITS, Chennai on May 9th,2023.
 - ▶ Participated in the International seminar titled “ Gender and Trauma : Integrating Gender and Issues of Trauma” conducted by School of Social Sciences and Languages , VITS Chennai on 18th May 2023.
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- ▶ Participated in the “ International Conference on Recent Trends in Teaching Learning Practices in Language, Literature, Humanities and Social Sciences- ICSSR TTP ,November 10-11th 2022. Presented a paper titled “ The Role Of Queer Characters in the Mahabharata”.

Papers Published

- ▶ 1 Representation of Women In Indian Mythology: A Feminist Perspective

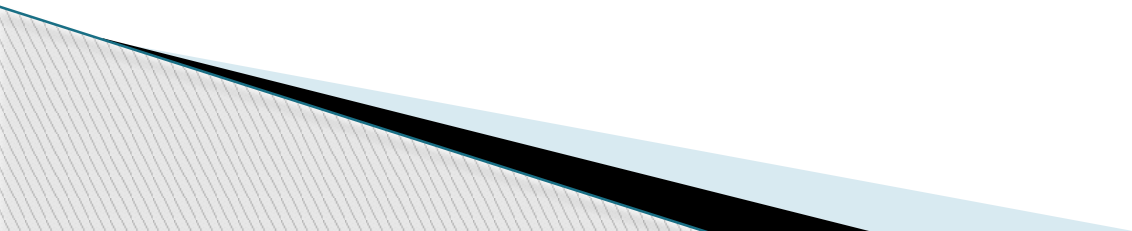
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